

THE NURTURE MOMS

Prenatal Yoga Starter Guide

Gentle, pregnancy-aware movement ideas to help you move, breathe and feel supported.

MOVE • BREATHE • CONNECT • PREPARE

“You don't need to push through pregnancy. You need movement that respects the changes happening in your body.”

From The Nurture Moms

A simple educational resource for expecting moms. It is not a substitute for individualized medical advice or a prenatal assessment.

1. Is Prenatal Yoga Right for You?

For many people with uncomplicated pregnancies, regular physical activity can be beneficial. Prenatal yoga can be one gentle way to maintain movement, mobility, breathing awareness and relaxation. Your healthcare professional can advise what is appropriate for your individual pregnancy.

Before you begin

- Tell your obstetrician/midwife about the type and intensity of exercise you want to do, especially if you are new to exercise.
- Choose a prenatal-trained instructor who understands pregnancy modifications.
- Use a comfortable pace — you should not feel that you have to compete, stretch deeply or hold difficult poses.
- As pregnancy progresses, modify positions for comfort and avoid lying flat on your back for prolonged periods if it makes you feel unwell.

High-risk pregnancy or medical concerns

If you have been advised that your pregnancy is high-risk, or you have complications such as placenta previa after 26 weeks, significant bleeding, preterm-labour risk, cervical insufficiency, ruptured membranes, severe anaemia or another medical concern, get individualized clearance before exercise. A generic online routine is not appropriate for every pregnancy.

2. The 5-Minute Pregnancy Reset

This is a gentle awareness routine rather than a fitness workout. Stop if anything feels painful, unusual or concerning.

1 minute — Comfortable breathing

Sit supported or stand comfortably. Let your shoulders soften. Breathe gently without forcing a deep breath.

1 minute — Shoulder & neck mobility

Slow shoulder rolls and comfortable neck movements. Keep the range easy.

1 minute — Cat-cow style mobility

On hands and knees if comfortable, slowly move between a neutral spine and a gentle rounded/extended position.

1 minute — Pelvic mobility

Standing with support, make small comfortable pelvic tilts or circles.

1 minute — Relaxation

Sit or stand supported. Relax your jaw, shoulders and hands and take several easy breaths.

This mini routine can be used as a gentle movement break. It is not intended to treat pain or pregnancy complications.

3. Gentle Prenatal Yoga Poses

The goal is comfort and mobility — not maximum flexibility.

Beginner-friendly options

- Supported child's pose: use a wide-knee position and pillows/bolsters so the belly has space.
- Cat-cow mobility: keep movements slow and comfortable; avoid forcing the spine.
- Supported side stretch: stay tall and create gentle length through the side body.
- Standing mountain with support: feet comfortable apart, hands on a wall or chair if needed.
- Supported squat: only if comfortable and appropriate for your pregnancy; use a wall/chair and do not force depth.
- Seated butterfly: sit comfortably and allow the knees to relax without pressing them down.
- Side-lying rest: use pillows to support the belly, knees and head.

Remember

Pregnancy changes balance, joint mobility and comfort. A pose that felt easy before pregnancy may need a smaller range, props or a different variation now.

4. Breathing & Relaxation

Pregnancy can be physically and emotionally demanding. Simple breathing and relaxation can help create moments of calm, but breathing practices should never make you dizzy or uncomfortable.

Try this 3-minute practice

- Sit supported with your spine comfortable.
- Relax the jaw, shoulders and hands.
- Breathe in gently through the nose if comfortable.
- Allow a soft, unforced exhale.
- Continue for several breaths without breath-holding or forcing the inhale.
- Finish by noticing how your body feels.

If you feel dizzy, light-headed, breathless beyond what is expected, or otherwise unwell, stop and rest.

5. What to Avoid or Modify

Prenatal yoga is about adapting movement to pregnancy — not trying to maintain your pre-pregnancy routine unchanged.

Common modifications

- Avoid activities with a high risk of falling or abdominal trauma.
- Avoid overheating and very hot yoga environments during pregnancy.
- Do not force deep twists or extreme ranges of motion.
- Use wider stances and props as the belly grows.
- Avoid prolonged flat-on-your-back exercise if it causes dizziness, nausea or discomfort.
- Avoid breath-holding or straining during movement.
- Do not continue through pain.

Always follow specific restrictions given by your obstetrician or midwife.

6. Movement by Trimester

Every pregnancy is different. The following is a simple framework, not a prescription.

Stage	Focus	Simple ideas
1st trimester	Comfort + consistency	Walking if cleared • gentle mobility • breathing • short sessions • rest when tired
2nd trimester	Mobility + support	Wider stance • supported poses • gentle strength/mobility • comfortable walking
3rd trimester	Comfort + preparation	Supported movement • pelvic mobility • breathing/relaxation • position changes • rest

The closer you get to birth, the more useful it can be to prioritize comfort, rest, breathing awareness and positions that feel supportive rather than chasing intensity.

7. A Simple 15-Minute Prenatal Flow

Use only movements that have been cleared and feel comfortable for you.

Minutes	Practice
0-2	Comfortable standing/sitting + easy breathing
2-5	Shoulder rolls + gentle neck/upper-back mobility
5-8	Cat-cow or supported spinal mobility
8-10	Supported side stretch + gentle pelvic mobility
10-12	Comfortable supported squat or standing mobility, if appropriate
12-15	Side-lying or supported seated relaxation

You can make the session shorter. Consistency and comfort matter more than completing a fixed routine.

8. Stop & Seek Medical Advice

Stop exercise and contact your maternity care team if you experience warning symptoms. Seek urgent medical care for severe or emergency symptoms.

Examples of symptoms that need medical attention

- Vaginal bleeding or leaking fluid.
- Regular painful contractions or signs of preterm labour.
- Chest pain, fainting or severe dizziness.
- Severe shortness of breath that is not normal for you.
- Severe headache or significant visual changes.
- Severe abdominal or pelvic pain.
- Calf pain/swelling or other symptoms that concern you.
- Any sudden or unusual symptom that worries you.

If you are unsure whether a symptom is safe to exercise through, pause the session and contact your healthcare professional.

9. Your Prenatal Yoga Checklist

Before every session

- Have I been cleared for the activity I am planning?
- Do I feel well enough to move today?
- Is the room comfortable and not overheated?
- Do I have water nearby?
- Do I have pillows, a chair, wall support or other props I may need?
- Am I willing to modify or stop a pose if it does not feel right?

**Gentle is not “less.”
Pregnancy is a season of adaptation.**

10. The Nurture Moms — Prenatal Yoga

At The Nurture Moms, prenatal yoga is designed around the real experience of motherhood — gentle movement, practical modifications, breathing and a supportive space.

Available formats

- Live prenatal yoga batches
- 1:1 pregnancy-focused sessions
- Pregnancy-aware movement and relaxation practices
- Support for different stages of pregnancy, with individualized medical clearance when needed

“Move through pregnancy with more support — not more pressure.”

[JOIN A PRENATAL YOGA SESSION →](#)

Educational resource only. This guide does not diagnose, treat or replace individualized care. Exercise recommendations can differ for high-risk pregnancies and medical conditions.

Sources: WHO recommendations on physical activity and antenatal care; NHS pregnancy exercise guidance; ACOG physical activity/exercise guidance during pregnancy and postpartum.

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THE NURTURE MOMS • For every stage of motherhood